

Northstar Knitwear & Apparels Pvt. Ltd.

Factory Standard Operating Procedure Manual

Reporting Period: August 2026

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Prepared by: Systems & Compliance Reviewed by: Factory Manager

Control	Details
Scope	Merchandising to Dispatch
Applies To	All departments and shifts
Effective	01-Sep-2026
Review	Annual or after major process change
Controlled By	Systems & Compliance

1. Purpose and Scope

This manual defines the minimum operating controls required for safe, consistent and traceable garment production at the Ludhiana unit. Department work instructions may add controls but shall not reduce these requirements.

2. Order Release Procedure

- Merchandising releases approved PO, tech pack, BOM, size chart, artwork and delivery date.
- Planning creates the T&A and line-loading plan.
- Stores confirms material availability against BOM before cutting release.
- QA confirms critical construction and measurement points for new styles.
- No bulk cutting is permitted without documented approval and material identification.

3. Fabric Store SOP

Step	Control	Record	Responsible
Receipt	PO, quantity, lot and supplier check	GRN + inspection	Stores
Inspection	4-point fabric inspection	Fabric inspection report	Fabric QC
Identification	Lot/color/GSM/width tag	Bin card	Stores
Issue	Against approved cut plan	Material issue slip	Stores
Balance	Return and reconcile remnants	Return note	Stores

4. Cutting SOP

Stage	Requirement	Critical Check
Spreading	Correct lot, ply, face direction	Shade / ply
Marker	Approved marker and ratio	Marker ID
Cutting	Sharp blade, correct notch	Panel accuracy
Bundling	Bundle ticket with size/color/order	Traceability
Audit	First bundle measurement check	QA sign-off

5. Printing SOP

- Verify artwork revision before screen preparation.
- Match ink, screen and substrate to approved strike-off.
- Record curing temperature/time.
- First 10 pieces require placement and shade verification.
- Rejected print panels are segregated and counted.

6. Embroidery SOP

- Confirm motif revision, thread shade and placement template.
- First-piece approval is mandatory before bulk panels.
- Check thread tension, needle condition and motif completeness.
- Record machine number and operator by lot.
- Rework is identified separately from fresh production.

7. Stitching SOP

Control	Frequency	Acceptance	Record
First-piece approval	Each style/shift	Critical operations pass	First-piece sheet
Needle check	Shift start + breakage	Correct undamaged needle	Needle log
SPI / seam allowance	Hourly	Within approved spec	Inline QC
Machine setting	Style change	Per operation bulletin	Setting sheet
Line audit	Every 2 hrs	Defect trend controlled	QA audit

8. Finishing and Packing SOP

- Trim threads, remove loose fibers and check appearance.
- Measure critical points to buyer specification.
- Fold and size-sort to packing ratio.
- Verify labels, barcode, polybag, carton marks and quantity.
- Seal cartons only after count verification.

9. Dispatch SOP

- Match invoice, packing list, PO, carton count and vehicle details.
- Confirm buyer-specific dispatch instructions.
- Photograph loaded cartons for priority shipments.
- Record seal number and dispatch time.
- Escalate any short shipment before vehicle departure.

10. Quality Escalation SOP

Trigger	Immediate Action	Escalate To	Target
Major defect >2%	Stop operation; segregate	Quality Manager	30 min
Shade mismatch	Stop lot; identify dye lot	Factory Manager + Merch.	30 min
Measurement failure	Hold lot; remeasure	QA + Production	1 hr
Metal detection failure	Stop packing	Quality Manager	Immediate
Buyer complaint	Contain stock; trace lot	Factory Manager	2 hrs

11. Machine Breakdown SOP

- Operator reports machine number and fault to supervisor/maintenance.
- Maintenance records start, fault, action and restoration time.
- Downtime >30 minutes is notified to Planning.
- Downtime >90 minutes on critical operation triggers work reallocation.
- Repeated breakdowns require preventive-maintenance review.

12. Material Shortage SOP

- Stores reports item, order, required quantity and production cover.
- Purchase confirms supplier ETA.
- Merchandising assesses buyer impact.
- Planning resequences lines where practical.
- Shortage threatening an ex-factory date within three working days is escalated.

13. Responsibility Matrix

Process	Primary	Secondary	Escalation
Order release	Merchandising	Planning	GM Operations
Material readiness	Stores	Purchase	Factory Manager
Production output	Production	IE	Factory Manager
Quality release	Quality	Production	Quality Manager
Dispatch readiness	Dispatch	Packing	Factory Manager

14. Records Retention

Record	Minimum Retention	Owner
PO / Tech Pack / Approvals	3 years	Merchandising
GRN / Fabric Inspection	3 years	Stores
Cutting / Bundle Records	2 years	Cutting
Inline / Final Inspection	3 years	Quality
Maintenance Logs	2 years	Maintenance
Dispatch Documents	3 years	Dispatch

15. Document Control

Changes to this manual require Factory Manager approval. Obsolete printed copies must be removed from points of use. Supervisors are responsible for briefing operators whenever a controlled procedure changes.

16. Escalation Contact Standard

Any issue affecting a customer commitment, production stoppage, quality release or material readiness must be notified immediately to the department head and recorded in the daily action register.